

Peachtree *Roofing* & Exteriors

- [Services](#)
- [Insurance Claims](#)
- [Storm Damage](#)
- [Service Area](#)
- [Free Estimate](#)

GEORGIA LAW UPDATE — 2026



Metro Atlanta, GA

New Georgia Law Could Help You Pay Your Roof Deductible — What Metro Atlanta Homeowners Need to Know

By Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors Published May 2026 🕒 8 min read



Georgia

House Bill 511

Effective 2026 — Catastrophe Savings Accounts now available to Georgia homeowners for qualifying storm deductibles.

Consult a Tax Professional

If you own a home in Atlanta — in Buckhead, Decatur, Marietta, Alpharetta, or anywhere else across DeKalb, Fulton, Cobb, or Gwinnett County — you've likely noticed something unsettling happening with your homeowner's insurance. Premiums are up. Insurers are scrutinizing roof ages more aggressively. Some policies have quietly shifted from replacement cost coverage to actual cash value for roofs over a certain age. And when storm season hits Metro Atlanta — as it did hard in March 2026 with high winds and falling trees — many homeowners are discovering that the gap between what their insurance pays and what a roof actually costs is larger than they expected.

That's the bad news. Here's the good news: Georgia passed House Bill 511, which introduces a new financial tool — Catastrophe Savings Accounts — that may help Metro Atlanta homeowners bridge that gap in a tax-advantaged way. At Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors, we want to make sure every homeowner in our service area understands this change, because your roof is your home's first line of defense, and the financial tools available to protect it just got better.

What is Georgia House Bill 511?

Under House Bill 511 (effective 2026), Georgia residents can establish Catastrophe Savings Accounts — dedicated savings vehicles that allow homeowners to set aside funds specifically for insurance deductibles related to natural disasters and severe weather events. Contributions may be tax-advantaged under state law. As with any tax strategy, you should consult a qualified tax professional to understand how this applies to your specific financial situation and policy.

Why This Matters for Atlanta Homeowners Right Now

Georgia's insurance landscape has shifted significantly in the past few years. Metro Atlanta sits in what insurers classify as a high-risk corridor for severe weather — hail, high winds, and the remnants of Gulf hurricanes all regularly pass through Fulton, DeKalb, Cobb, and Gwinnett counties. The result has been a quiet but significant restructuring of how insurers handle roof

claims in Georgia.

In 2026, many Metro Atlanta insurers are assessing the age and condition of your roof to determine whether your claim will be paid at full replacement cost value (RCV) or actual cash value (ACV). The difference is substantial:

Coverage Type	What It Pays	Example: 15-Year Roof, \$18,000 Replacement Cost
Replacement Cost Value (RCV)	Full cost to replace at today's prices, minus deductible	~\$16,500 payout (minus \$1,500 deductible)
Actual Cash Value (ACV)	Depreciated value of the old roof, minus deductible	~\$6,000-\$8,000 payout — leaving \$10,000-\$12,000 gap

For a homeowner who bought their house in Smyrna or Stone Mountain in 2008 and has a roof that's now 17 or 18 years old, the shift from RCV to ACV coverage — often triggered automatically based on roof age — can mean a difference of thousands of dollars out of pocket. A Catastrophe Savings Account is specifically designed to help close that gap.

The 2026 Atlanta Roofing Insurance Landscape:

What You Need to Know

1. Know Your Coverage Type Before the Storm Hits

The worst time to discover you have ACV coverage is when you're standing in your living room watching rain come through a hole in your ceiling after a storm. Call your insurance agent today and ask specifically: "Is my roof covered at replacement cost value or actual cash value?" If it's ACV, ask what age threshold triggers the change — and whether there are riders or endorsements that restore RCV coverage.

 Watch for Non-Renewal Notices

Insurers across Metro Atlanta have been sending non-

renewal notices to homeowners with roofs over 15-20

years old. If you've received one — or suspect you might

— contact a licensed roofing contractor for a documented

inspection report before your policy lapses. A professional

inspection showing your roof is in good condition can

sometimes support policy retention or renewal with a new

carrier.

2. Document Everything, Before You Need It

Insurance claims move faster — and pay better — when homeowners have documented their roof's condition before damage occurs. At Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors, we provide written inspection reports with photographs that homeowners can keep on file. If a storm rolls through your neighborhood in Lawrenceville, Woodstock, or Johns Creek, having a pre-storm baseline gives you and your adjuster a clear picture of what was new damage versus pre-existing conditions.

3. Understand the Catastrophe Savings Account Strategy

A Catastrophe Savings Account under HB 511 isn't a magic bullet — it doesn't change what your insurer owes you. What it does is help you accumulate funds, potentially with tax advantages, that are designated specifically for disaster-related deductibles and out-of-pocket costs. If your deductible is a percentage of your home's insured value (common in storm-prone areas of Georgia), that number can be significant — often \$3,000–\$8,000 or more for a Metro Atlanta home. Having dedicated savings for that specific purpose, set aside before a

storm, is a meaningful financial resilience strategy.

01

Review your policy today

Ask your agent specifically about RCV vs. ACV coverage for

your roof, and your current deductible structure.

02

Consult a tax professional

HB 511 Catastrophe Savings Accounts have specific rules.

A CPA familiar with Georgia law can help you set one up

correctly.

03

Schedule a roof inspection

Know your roof's current condition. A documented

inspection report is your baseline for any future claim —

and may support policy renewal.

04

Act before storm season peaks

Atlanta's storm season runs April through September.

Repairs and inspections done before damage occurs are

always less expensive than emergency work after.

The Peachtree Roofing Approach to Insurance Claims in Georgia

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors has worked with hundreds of Metro Atlanta homeowners through the insurance claims process. We know which documentation adjusters look for, how to capture hail impact patterns and wind damage in ways that

support a complete claim, and how to communicate clearly with carriers so your repair or replacement moves efficiently from inspection to approval to completion.

We work across the full Metro Atlanta area — from Cherokee County in the north to Henry County in the south, from Douglas County in the west to Gwinnett County in the east. Every roof we inspect gets a written report that homeowners can use for insurance purposes, real estate transactions, or simply their own peace of mind.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors — Georgia Service Area

Fulton CountyAtlanta, Sandy Springs, Alpharetta,

Roswell, Milton, Johns Creek

DeKalb CountyDecatur, Chamblee, Dunwoody, Tucker,

Lithonia, Doraville

Cobb County Marietta, Smyrna, Kennesaw, Acworth,

Powder Springs, Vinings

Gwinnett County Lawrenceville, Duluth, Norcross,

Suwanee, Buford, Snellville

Cherokee County Canton, Woodstock, Ball Ground, Holly

Springs, Waleska

Henry & Clayton McDonough, Stockbridge, Hampton,

Don't Wait for the Next Storm

The March 2026 storms that moved through Metro Atlanta — bringing high winds, tornado warnings, and trees through roofs across the region — were a stark reminder that severe weather in Georgia doesn't announce itself politely. Families across DeKalb and Fulton Counties dealt with emergency tarping, insurance adjusters, and contractor queues all at once, all in the middle of the chaos of active storm damage.

The homeowners who navigated that process most smoothly were the ones who had already done the preparation: they knew their coverage, they had documented roof condition, and they had financial reserves set aside for exactly this kind of event. Georgia's House Bill 511 gives you a new, structured way to do that third piece.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors is here to help you do the first two. A free inspection, a written report, and an honest conversation about what your roof needs — that's how we start every relationship with a new Atlanta homeowner. Give us a call, and let's make sure you're ready for whatever this storm season brings.

Schedule Your Free Roof Inspection — Written Report Included

Serving all of Metro Atlanta: Fulton, DeKalb, Cobb, Gwinnett, Cherokee, Henry, and surrounding counties.

BOOK FREE INSPECTION →

Disclaimer: This post is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal, financial, or tax advice. Georgia House Bill 511 and insurance policy terms are subject to change. Consult a licensed tax professional and your insurance agent for guidance specific to your situation.

Free Roof Inspection

Written report included. No obligation. We serve all of Metro

Atlanta.

(404) 555-0190 [SCHEDULE ONLINE →](#)

Georgia Roof Stats 2026

Avg. roof lifespan (asphalt)**20-25 yrs**

ACV trigger age (most GA policies)**15-20 yrs**

Avg. Metro Atlanta replacement cost**\$14k-\$22k**

Typical storm deductible (% policy)**1%-2% home value**

Storm season peak (GA)**Apr-Sep**

Questions for Your Insurer

→ Is my roof covered at RCV or ACV?

→ At what age does my coverage change?

→ What is my storm deductible — flat or percentage?

→ Is there an endorsement to restore RCV coverage?

→ Am I at risk of non-renewal based on roof age?

Related Reading

→ Chamblee Apartment Fire: What Atlanta Homeowners

Should Inspect Now

→ March 2026 Storm Damage: Your First Steps After a Tree

Hits Your Roof

→ How to Read Your Roof Inspection Report

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors — Licensed Georgia Roofing Contractor

Proudly serving Fulton, DeKalb, Cobb, Gwinnett, Cherokee, Henry, Clayton & surrounding Metro Atlanta counties.